

Near-extremal graph with fixed defect s
Theorem C', fixed-defect hypotheses



Low-degree deletion with evolving deficit
(6.15); induction window in Appendix F.1



Controlled terminal: clique root and retained accounts
(6.14)



Reinsert deleted vertices: one root in the original graph
Edit and baseline bounds (6.12)



Keep this root for every partition
Piece count and edge mass
(6.13), derived through (6.16)



Resize to an optimal-size template
Corollary 6.3; additional square-root cost
Worst-case obstruction: Proposition 6.3a